

Thursday, 30 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 27° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 24° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 20° 16°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Much of the UK is bracing for another day of high temperatures, with amber heat health alerts in force across many areas.

Wednesday is expected to be the hottest day of the week for many, as a widespread fourth heatwave grips the nation. Health officials are urging people to stay hydrated and check on vulnerable neighbours.

WEATHER · UK
- 2

Police Scotland are investigating after the body of a Scottish woman was reportedly found inside a suitcase in Greece.

Authorities confirmed they are liaising with Greek police after the discovery was made by a homeless man in Athens last month. Details surrounding the incident are still emerging.

CRIME · UK
- 3

The Prime Minister has urged a focus on palliative care before any fresh debate on legalising assisted dying in England and Wales.

His comments suggest he will not personally back a new attempt to legalise assisted dying. This comes as the sensitive topic continues to be a point of discussion.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

A pedestrian has tragically died after being hit by several vehicles, including a police car, in a serious incident.

Dyfed-Powys Police have referred themselves to the Independent Office of Police Conduct following the collision. Investigations are now underway to determine the circumstances.

INCIDENT · UK
- 5

A chief constable has resigned from his post ahead of a scheduled misconduct tribunal.

Chris Noble was suspended in August and was facing a hearing regarding his behaviour. His resignation means the tribunal will no longer proceed.

POLICE · UK

What's coming up

- 1** **Strictly Come Dancing is welcoming another familiar face to the ballroom, with House of the Dragon star Bethany Antonia joining the line-up.**

Bethany, who plays Lady Baela Targaryen in the Game of Thrones prequel, is the ninth celebrity confirmed for the upcoming series. Fans will be eager to see her dance moves.

| ON AIR – Who are you most excited to see on Strictly this year?

TV · AUTUMN
- 2** **Congratulations are in order for pop star Madison Beer and NFL player Justin Herbert, who have announced their engagement!**

The happy couple shared the news on social media on Tuesday, including photos from the romantic proposal. It's a lovely piece of news for their fans.

| ON AIR – What's the most romantic proposal you've ever heard of?

CELEBRITY · NOW
- 3** **The prestigious Booker Prize longlist has been revealed, featuring 13 'dynamite' novels vying for this year's award.**

Renowned authors Elizabeth Strout, Douglas Stuart, and Marlon James are among those recognised. It's always exciting to see which books make the cut.

| ON AIR – Have you read any of the longlisted books, or do you have a favourite author you hope makes it?

BOOKS · AUTUMN
- 4** **Strictly professional Amy Dowden has credited her dance partner for convincing her not to quit dancing during a tough time.**

Amy and Carlos Gu are set to star in the latest series of Celebrity Hunted. It's wonderful to hear she's back on the dancefloor and feeling strong.

| ON AIR – Who has been your biggest motivator or inspiration when you've faced a challenge?

TV · AUTUMN
- 5** **Influencer Nara Smith has received a huge outpouring of support after revealing her toddler daughter was diagnosed with cancer.**

In an emotional video, Nara shared the difficult news that Whimsy Lou received her diagnosis late last year. It's a reminder of the challenges many families face.

| ON AIR – How important is it to see public figures share their personal struggles to help others feel less alone?

CELEBRITY · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Manchester Super Giants secured a four-wicket win over Sunrisers Leeds in The Hundred, thanks to a magnificent performance from Smriti Mandhana.**

Mandhana powered her team to victory with an impressive 88 runs off just 50 balls, including four sixes. It was a thrilling match at Headingley.

ON AIR – Who's your favourite player to watch in The Hundred?

CRICKET · UK
- 2 Three-time major champion Padraig Harrington has been named as one of Luke Donald's vice-captains for the Ryder Cup in 2027.**

Harrington will bring a wealth of experience to the team as they prepare for the prestigious event at Adare Manor. It's a big boost for the European side.

ON AIR – What makes a great Ryder Cup captain or vice-captain?

GOLF · INTERNATIONAL
- 3 Just five months after giving birth, new mum Georgia Hall is ready to return to the major stage at the course where she won the 2018 Women's Open.**

It's an incredible comeback story for the golfer, who is feeling prepared to compete at the highest level. She'll be hoping for another strong performance.

ON AIR – What's the most impressive sporting comeback you've ever witnessed?

GOLF · UK
- 4 Formula 1 president Stefano Domenicali has stated that the 2026 championship will end in Europe if conflict in the Middle East continues.**

This decision would be made if holding the season-closing races in Qatar and Abu Dhabi becomes impossible. It highlights the global challenges facing the sport.

ON AIR – How do you think global events impact major sporting calendars?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL
- 5 Nottingham Forest are reportedly close to completing a deal for Sporting Lisbon defender Ousmane Diomande.**

The potential signing would be a significant boost for Forest as they look to strengthen their squad. Fans will be eager to see if the deal goes through.

ON AIR – Which transfer rumour are you most excited about this week?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful art of 'book spine poetry' is becoming a quiet trend amongst bibliophiles.**
It involves arranging books so their titles on the spine create a short, whimsical poem. It's a lovely way to breathe new life into your bookshelf and spark a bit of creativity.
- 2 Researchers are finding that the simple act of 'doodling during meetings' can actually improve concentration and memory.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, those little drawings can help keep your brain engaged and process information more effectively, apparently!
- 3 The charm of 'hand-written thank you notes' is making a big comeback in our digital age.**
People are finding that a personal, physical note carries so much more warmth and sincerity than a quick email or text. It's a lovely touch that really stands out.
- 4 A new study suggests that 'having a 'default' happy song' ready to play can quickly shift your mood.**
Apparently, having that go-to tune that instantly lifts your spirits can be a powerful tool for a quick emotional boost, whenever you need it.
- 5 The satisfying ritual of 'watering houseplants' is being recognised as a genuine stress-reducer.**
Connecting with nature, even indoors, and nurturing something green can be incredibly calming and bring a moment of peace to a busy day.
- 6 The joy of 'discovering a forgotten fiver' in an old coat pocket is consistently rated as a top small happiness.**
That unexpected little windfall, however small, brings a disproportionate amount of delight. It's like a tiny gift from your past self!
- 7 There's a growing appreciation for 'the art of making a perfectly crisp sandwich'.**
From the bread choice to the crisp distribution, enthusiasts are detailing their methods for achieving that ideal crunch. It's a serious business for some!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our keys just before leaving the house, even though we know it's a bit superstitious?

ANSWER: GIVING THEM A LITTLE JINGLE OR TAPPING THEM TOGETHER FOR 'GOOD LUCK'.

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, freshly baked biscuit. What is it?

ANSWER: SNIFFING IT DEEPLY, AS IF TO ABSORB ALL THE DELICIOUSNESS BEFORE THE FIRST BITE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those 'little everyday sounds' that are just pure comfort to you, almost like a sonic hug?**
Perhaps it's the gentle hum of the fridge, the distant rumble of a train, or even the sound of the kettle boiling. What are those sounds that just make you feel instantly at home and content?

- **We all have those 'unusual item combinations' that we absolutely love, even if others find them a bit peculiar!**
Maybe it's dipping chips in milkshake, pineapple on pizza, or a very specific sandwich filling. What's your go-to unusual food combination that you swear by?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the collective noun for a group of mischievous monkeys is a 'chatter'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Black Death by burning down the rat-infested buildings.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, reaching altitudes of around 9,000 metres.
- Before alarm clocks, there were 'knocker-uppers' in Britain who would tap on windows with long poles to wake people for work.
- A typical cloud weighs about 550 tons, which is roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- The world's first successful photograph was taken in 1826 by French inventor Joseph Nicéphore Niépce.
- Pineapples take about two to three years to grow, from planting to harvest.
- The scent of freshly cut grass is actually a distress signal released by the plants.
- The sound of a human belch has been recorded at a staggering 109.9 decibels, louder than a chainsaw.

On this day

Day 211 of the year, 154 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdon and Sennen; Christian feast day: Blessed Edward Powell, Richard Fetherston and Thomas Abel; Christian feast day: Hatebrand; Christian feast day: María Natividad Venegas de la Torre. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Arnold Schwarzenegger, Austrian-American bodybuilder, actor, and politician, 38th Governor of California
- 1941 — Paul Anka, Canadian singer-songwriter and actor
- 1946 — Jeffrey Hammond, English bass player
- 1970 — Dean Edwards, American comedian, actor, and singer
- 1980 — Justin Rose, South African-English golfer
- 1948 — Otis Taylor, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1991 — Diana Vickers, English singer-songwriter
- 1982 — James Anderson, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Apollo program: On Apollo 15, David Scott and James Irwin in the Apollo Lunar Module Falcon land on the Moon with the first Lunar Rover.
- 1980 — Vanuatu gains independence.
- 1990 — Ian Gow, Conservative Member of Parliament, is assassinated at his home by the IRA in a car bombing after he assured the group that the British government would never surrender to them.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The 730: Okinawa Prefecture changes its traffic on the right-hand side of the road to the left-hand side.
- 2025 — A magnitude 8.8 earthquake hits Russia, causing tsunamis over the Pacific Ocean.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — Israel's Knesset passes the Jerusalem Law.
- 2011 — Marriage of Queen Elizabeth II's eldest granddaughter Zara Phillips to former rugby union footballer Mike Tindall.

- 2006 — An Israeli airstrike kills 28 Lebanese civilians, including 16 children.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 212 of the year, 153 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abanoub; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecília Schelingová; Christian feast day: Blessed Solanus Casey; Christian feast day: Fabius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Susan Flannery, American actress
- 1974 — Leona Naess, American-English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Gary Lewis, American pop-rock musician
- 1959 — Kim Newman, English journalist and author
- 1981 — Titus Bramble, English footballer
- 1963 — Fergus Henderson, English chef and author
- 1965 — J. K. Rowling, English author and film producer
- 1970 — Ben Chaplin, English actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1941 — The Holocaust: Under instructions from Adolf Hitler, Nazi official Hermann Göring orders SS General Reinhard Heydrich to "submit to me as soon as possible a general plan of the administrative material and financial measures necessary for carrying out the desired Final Solution..."
- 1975 — The Troubles: Three members of a popular cabaret band and two gunmen are killed during a botched paramilitary attack in Northern Ireland.
- 1999 — Discovery Program: Lunar Prospector: NASA intentionally crashes the spacecraft into the Moon, thus ending its mission to detect frozen water on the Moon's surface.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The Troubles: Three members of a popular cabaret band and two gunmen are killed during a botched paramilitary attack in Northern Ireland.
- 1970 — Black Tot Day: The last day of the officially sanctioned rum ration in the Royal Navy.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)